

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Defensive Operations | Threat Hunting | Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience in defensive security operations, threat hunting, and detection engineering. I have a proven track record of conducting advanced investigations using Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), authoring Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules aligned with the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and supporting the full incident response lifecycle in accordance with NIST 800-61 standards. I am experienced in overseeing Managed Detection and Response (MDR) and Managed Security Service Provider (MSSP) quality, participating in joint detection tuning sessions, and converting threat intelligence and hunting findings into actionable detection logic. I am passionate about protecting organisations from cyber threats, maturing Defensive Operations (DefOps) capability, and contributing to the ongoing improvement of security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), detection rule authoring, log analysis, data correlation, alert tuning
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/Prevent/Insight/Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Threat Hunting and Intelligence:** MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat-led hunting, Indicators of Compromise (IOC) analysis, proactive threat identification
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, full IR lifecycle (detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, lessons learned), IR playbook development
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR):** Playbook development, automated alert triage, workflow automation
- **Identity and Access:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)/Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, ISO 27001, NCSC CAF, NIS 2 Directive, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials+
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, KQL
- **Other Tools:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall, Tanium, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts London (UAL), London

- Lead advanced threat investigations escalated from the MDR Security Operations Centre (SOC), conducting root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation across Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR, covering an 8,000-user enterprise environment.
- Develop and execute threat hunts based on threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, converting findings into detection rules and tuning recommendations authored in KQL within Microsoft Sentinel.
- Support incident response activities through the full lifecycle including detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned; author and maintain IR playbooks and procedures aligned with NIST 800-61.
- Oversee MSSP and MDR provider quality assurance: review escalation quality, provide structured feedback, and participate in joint detection tuning and threat intelligence sharing sessions.
- Configure, maintain, and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), ensuring optimal detection policy coverage across endpoints and servers.

- Administer Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender), managing policy, alert investigations, and integration with Sentinel for unified detection and response.
- Manage the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, tracking remediation in line with risk-based prioritisation and reporting to senior stakeholders.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM, enforcing least privilege access and supporting investigations into privileged account activity.
- Develop SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and analyst workload.
- Maintain alignment with ISO 27001, NIST CSF, NCSC CAF, CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials+ frameworks, contributing to evidence gathering and control assessments.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts London (UAL), London

- Monitored SIEM and EDR platforms daily for security events, conducting alert triage, log analysis, investigation, and escalation of potential incidents.
- Supported incident response investigations from detection through to containment and recovery, assisting with evidence gathering and root cause analysis.
- Contributed to the development of detection rules and alert tuning guidance, improving signal-to-noise ratio across the SIEM estate.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck; tracked remediation activity and reported on risk posture.
- Administered Azure AD Conditional Access, MFA, and role-based access control (RBAC) policies, supporting identity security and access reviews.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline security operations tasks and reduce manual effort.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ compliance programmes, gathering evidence and supporting control assessments.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech), London

- Delivered security assessments and improvement initiatives across a Software as a Service (SaaS) and FinTech cloud infrastructure environment.
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials compliance programmes, contributing to audit preparation and evidence gathering.
- Managed endpoint security controls, network security tooling, and IT infrastructure across cloud and on-premises systems.
- Provided security and IT infrastructure engineering support, improving platform resilience and security posture.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced mean time to detect (MTTD) at UAL by designing and deploying a MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection engineering programme in Microsoft Sentinel, building a library of KQL detection rules informed by threat intelligence and active threat hunting findings.
- Elevated MSSP oversight maturity by establishing a structured quality assurance process for MDR escalations, including joint tuning sessions and formal feedback loops that improved escalation accuracy and reduced false positive volume.
- Developed a comprehensive suite of IR playbooks aligned with NIST 800-61, standardising the organisation's incident response capability and reducing remediation time for common threat scenarios.
- Deployed and configured SOAR automation in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing analyst alert triage workload and significantly improving MTTR across the SOC.

- Achieved CISSP certification, demonstrating breadth of expertise across all eight domains of information security including Security and Risk Management, Identity and Access Management, and Software Development Security.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-90,000+ | Remote (UK)